Video Transcript

Video 1: Introduction (02:10)

The big data and distributed computation platforms broke new ground and gave us the capacity to deal with the volume, variety, and velocity that is typical of big data. However, there were a number of shortcomings as well, and that's usual when it comes to first generations of any type of idea. We needed something that was easier, that was simpler, and that was faster, and that brought about a new generation of analytical engines. Now, thankfully, these are all open source, which means that we can get access to the full source code, and we can modify them and run them without having to pay for licenses. Now, this is a great one to know and understand the adoption in industry is wide, and it is one that has a very active community. So, this is the one that we'll be taking a look next. If you've been in computation for long, you're familiar with trying to create some scripts to be able to automate some tasks that you're trying to perform, to trying to shortcut the number of manual steps that you need to take.

Now oftentimes, some of these become ones that our organizations are dependent on, which means that they need to go through a maturity curve. There's many cases you didn't consider when you were simply running on your machine. And some of these might be failures, monitoring, conditional dependencies, scale, deployment, history, we could go through a long painful list really here of what those are. Now, thankfully there are some platforms that look precisely at this type of scenarios. They're called workflow engines. And in this case, we're going to be looking at one that was born in the data engineering world, which means that was looking at a lot of the pipelines that data engineers were building. And that is a great fit for many projects, that it is widely used in the community, and it is one that is very helpful to know. So, let's go ahead and jump in, and take a look at a workflow engine.

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